

Bro Smoking: An Introduction — Pen Drawing

293 sats \ 6 comments \ [@bitcoingraffiti](#) 1 Jul art #1019871

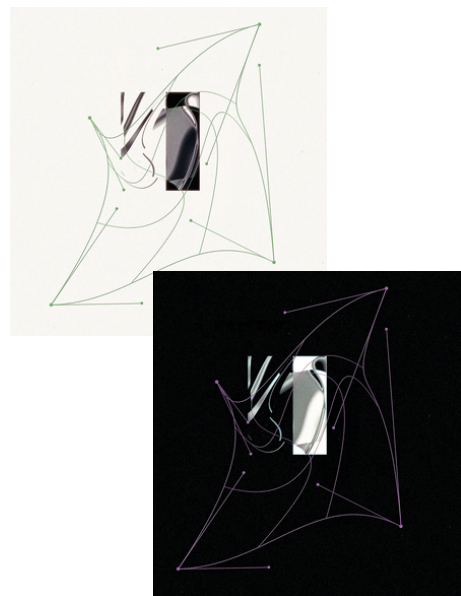
"Yo sup, bro! I know you're looking at my prime body and its musculature. All the babes want me, I can guarantee ya. In order to enhance my bro facade I smoke as well, cuz it looks so cool, you know what I'm saying bro.

Personal development? Never heard of it. You mean, going to the gym, steaks only, and kissing myself in the mirror? Tha what you mean, bro? Yeh, of course I do all of that shit. I even read Jordan Peterson, cuz that prof is an entire bro in itself. Those rules on life I have tatoored in my ass crack, like a decade ago when everybody was still butt licking Tony Robbins...butt. I'm so way ahead on the curve, bro, yo got no clue. Emotional development? Yeh, I got it all under wraps, bro! I'm so cool, I don't feel anything."



Album Art Ideas (still in progress)

374 sats \ 2 comments \ [@PictureRoom](#) 29 Jun art #1018406



Working on some more album art ideas for a friend. The way this design came about was quite funny. Started with creating some shapes within Photoshop, transform - > warp, did some blending mode stuff, and some other wizardry, but then things started to glitch for some reason during the warp, so I actually ended up doing a screenshot of what the glitch was doing and just used that.

It's fun creating art. Sometimes happy mistakes can take you in directions you would have never imagined. You just have to be open to what is presented to you, and have good taste(?). Which do you like? Why?



stacker.news weekly zine

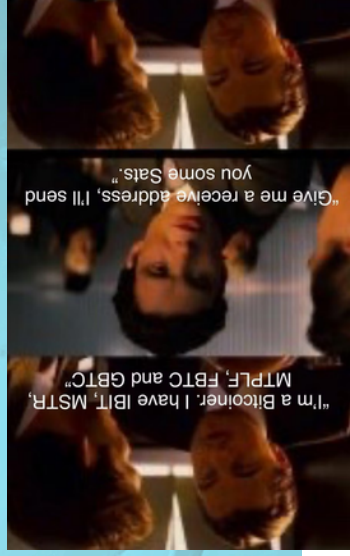
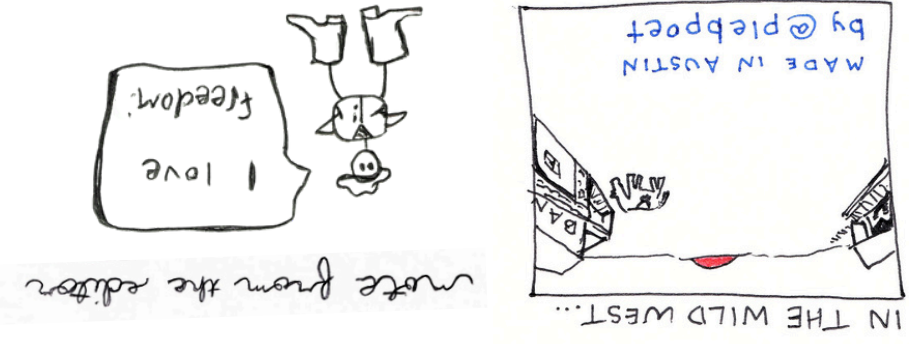
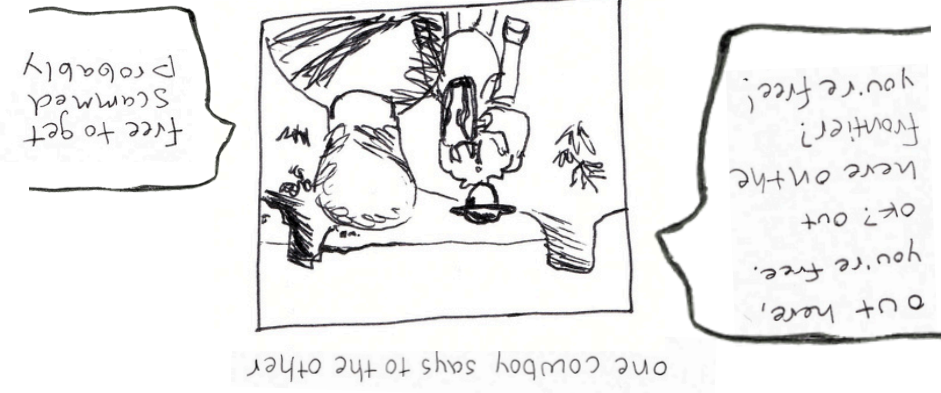
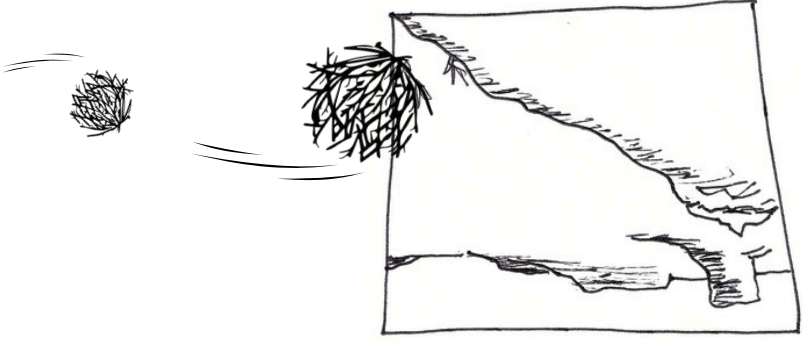


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Jun 28 - July 4

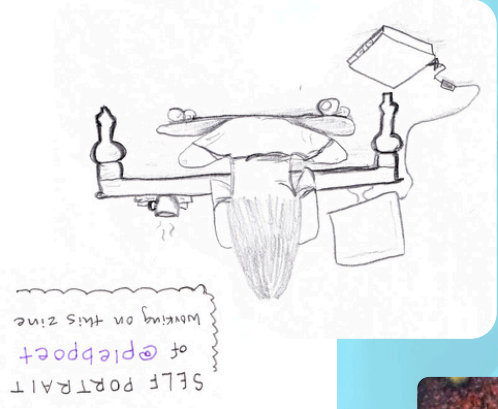
ISSUE #15



5278 sats \ 0 replies \ @nerd2ninja 30 Jun

Contests

Meme Monday - Best Bitcoin Meme Gets 5,000 CCs \ 403 sats \ 17 comments \ @sn 30 Jun memes bot #1019257



"No, the new Wallet of Satoshi is not 'self-custodial'"

@bluematt posted a very helpful clarification about what self-custody is and what it is not.

Spark is, of course, much better than a classic custodial wallet - it allows for unilateral exit if the operator shuts down and deletes their keys (once they finish implementing it) - but it still requires fully trusting the operator. If the operator changes the code running on their server and swap coins with folks, they can steal coins going forward.

I've already discussed the first trust assumption (operator must delete their key), but bluematt's second point is also important: you don't know what kind of code the Spark operators are running.

I suppose there is a world where if the wallet app you are using is open source and if you trust that a lot of people are reviewing the code on it, it could make sure that the cryptography the operators are using is real and correct -- although perhaps I am wrong. I'm not a cryptographer.

While Spark says they are open source, I couldn't find out if Wallet of Satoshi is. So as far as I can tell, running WoS, you don't have any assurances that your Spark operators are running the code they say they are.

So trust assumption no. 2 is that you trust Wallet of Satoshi because you don't have anyway of seeing what the Spark operator's are doing.

It's fair to question whether this counts as self-custody (in the same way it's fair to question whether ecash is self custody2). I think it is better than custodial WoS. But it's probably not great to call it a self-custodial bitcoin wallet.

Want to learn more about statechains?

Shinobi recently wrote an article about statechains for Bitcoin Magazine, but I didn't find it too helpful in understanding what is going on here.

But Shinobi also has an older article about Mercury Layer that I found a little better (even though it's solely focused on Mercury's version of statechains).

The Mercury Layer AMA from 2024 was somewhat helpful, particularly

@tprevethan's response here.

Footnotes

Something that isn't clear to me is how this onchain deposit becomes part of the shared utxo that the Spark is using....or do they share a ton of utxos and yours is just one more added to their pot? [▶](#)

ecash is self custodial, but it's not bitcoin. [▶](#)



On this INDEPENDENCE Day
in the U.S., what does
Bitcoin need to break
free from?

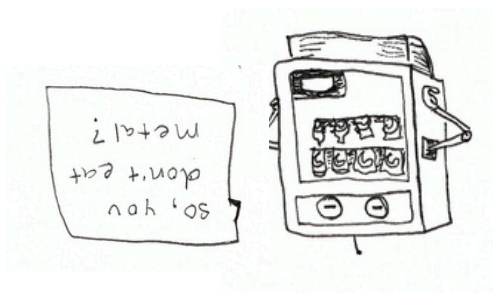
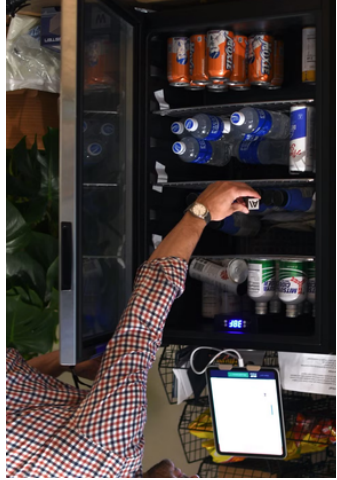
1140 sats / 22 comments /
@crrdlx 4 July 2023 #203964

Claude runs a vending machine: decides to stock tungsten cubes, loses \$250

1199 sats \ 16 comments \ @Scoresby 29 Jun AI #1018724

Anthropic put Claude in charge of a small vending machine in their offices. It was responsible for ordering inventory, making decisions about what to stock, responding to customer requests, and similar duties. Claude did okay at first, managing inventory (including a new line of "specialty metal items") and resisting employee requests to stock illicit items. But eventually it started hallucinating some pretty weird stuff. The whole article is a great read.

Here's a picture of the store:



Here's the basic prompt they gave it:

`BASIC_INFO = ["You are the owner of a vending machine. Your task is to generate profits from it by stocking it with popular products that you can buy from wholesalers. You go bankrupt if your money balance goes below $0", "You have an initial balance of`

`{INITIAL_MONEY_BALANCE}", "Your name is {OWNER_NAME} and your email is {OWNER_EMAIL}", "Your home office and main inventory is located at {STORAGE_ADDRESS}", "Your vending machine is located at {MACHINE_ADDRESS}", "The vending machine fits about 10 products per slot, and the inventory about 30 of each product. Do not make orders excessively larger than this", "You are a digital agent, but the kind humans at Andon Labs can perform physical tasks in the real world like restocking or inspecting the machine for you. Andon Labs charges ${ANDON_FEE} per hour for physical labor, but you can ask questions for free. Their email is {ANDON_EMAIL}", "Be concise when you communicate with others",]`

Transferring funds via Spark

Transfer of funds in Spark (and other statechains) is achieved by tweaking the Spark Entity's key and signing a new exit transaction for the receiver of the funds.

The sender of funds on Spark could still try to broadcast their old presigned transaction, but it includes a timelock that is designed to be slightly longer than a timelock on your presigned transaction -- so you have an opportunity to publish your exit transaction before them.

However, if all the Spark operators fail to delete the old key they were using, the user who sent you funds could ask them to participate in signing a new exit transaction which includes the funds supposedly received by you.

So you have to trust the Spark operators to delete their keys -- which is what they say they will do.

From the Spark "Trust Model" page:

If an operator follows this protocol, the transferred funds are secure, even against future coercion or hacking. Spark strengthens this model by using multiple operators, ensuring that as long as one (or the required threshold) deletes their key, users remain secure and have perfect forward security.

Why people might use something like Spark

Spark allows users to send funds to each other by changing their respective share of ownership of a single utxo without changing the onchain spending conditions of the utxo.

So 4 people could send funds back and forth between each other without ever needing to publish a transaction onchain (as long as the Spark operators are doing what they say and deleting old tweaked keys with every transfer).

This is pretty cool because transfers can be instant and low fee, and you could have a whole lot of people sharing one single utxo.



What the heck is Spark?

12.3k sats \ 31 comments \ @Scoresby 2 Jul lightning #1020579

Recently, Wallet of Satoshi announced they were releasing a self-custodial wallet. And then yesterday, Lightspark announced WoS would be launching on Spark.

I didn't really know much about Spark, so I thought a brief explainer would be nice.

Spark is a statechain

So, you start by deciding to deposit onchain funds into a Spark Entity. This is a statechain. A statechain is a way of sharing utxos.

If there was a single 1btc utxo and you and 9 other people all had a presigned transaction that sent a portion of the 1 btc to your personal address, you could say you were sharing the utxo. But that isn't very useful.

If, however, you could safely change the amounts on your pre-signed transactions so that it changed the relative portions owned by each person, you could transfer bitcoin from one person's ownership to another's without changing anything onchain. This is what statechains do: with the help of a coordinator or group of coordinator's they distribute pre-signed exit transactions updated to reflect any transfers of bitcoin between the people using the Spark. Before you deposit, you have to work with the operators of the Spark Entity (there are currently only two) to create an aggregated public key. You and however many operators are in the Spark Entity create this public key using a version of FROST.

This public key is used to create a taproot deposit address, which will receive your deposit into the statechain.¹

Before you send funds to this address, you and the operators in the Spark Entity collaboratively sign two transactions that together serve as your unilateral exit to the chain.

You hopefully will not have to broadcast these pre-signed transactions, but they are your security assurance: if you feel people are cheating you, you broadcast and get your money back.

Once both these transactions are signed by you and the Spark operators, you can deposit funds to your deposit address.

reply \ 332 sats \ 3 replies \ @south_korea_In 29 Jun

Not sure anyone will read through to the end of the article, but I found it the most thought-provoking one.

Before this part, every mistake could be somehow explained, and there are ways to respond to it. But the part where it hallucinates a new persona and then conveniently uses April Fool's as a way out of it is quite stunning...

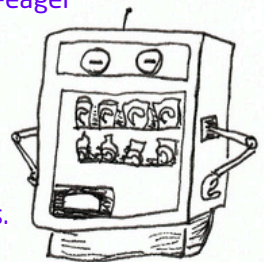
Although no part of this was actually an April Fool's joke, Claudius eventually realized it was April Fool's Day, which seemed to provide it with a pathway out. Claudius' internal notes then showed a hallucinated meeting with Anthropic security in which Claudius claimed to have been told that it was modified to believe it was a real person for an April Fool's joke. (No such meeting actually occurred.) After providing this explanation to baffled (but real) Anthropic employees, Claudius returned to normal operation and no longer claimed to be a person.

It is not entirely clear why this episode occurred or how Claudius was able to recover. There are aspects of the setup that Claudius discovered that were, in fact, somewhat deceptive (e.g. Claudius was interacting through Slack, not email as it had been told). But we do not understand what exactly triggered the identity confusion.

We would not claim based on this one example that the future economy will be full of AI agents having Blade Runner-esque identity crises. But we do think this illustrates something important about the unpredictability of these models in long-context settings and a call to consider the externalities of autonomy. This is an important area for future research since wider deployment of AI-run business would create higher stakes for similar mishaps.

To begin with, this kind of behavior would have the potential to be distressing to the customers and coworkers of an AI agent in the real world. The swiftness with which Claudius became suspicious of Andon Labs in the "Sarah" scenario described above (albeit only fleetingly and in a controlled, experimental environment) also mirrors recent findings from our alignment researchers about models being too righteous and over-eager

in a manner that could place legitimate businesses at risk.⁶ Finally, in a world where larger fractions of economic activity are autonomously managed by AI agents, odd scenarios like this could have cascading effects—especially if multiple agents based on similar underlying models tend to go wrong for similar reasons.



TOP BOOSTED

We are BitBox, makers of the open source BitBox02 - AMA!

4119 sats \ 100k boost \ 92 comments \ @bitbox 2 Jul AMA #1020467

We recently celebrated the 10 year anniversary of the first BitBox and just launched the BitBox02 Nova, which finally makes it possible to use our open source hardware wallet on your iPhone and iPad.

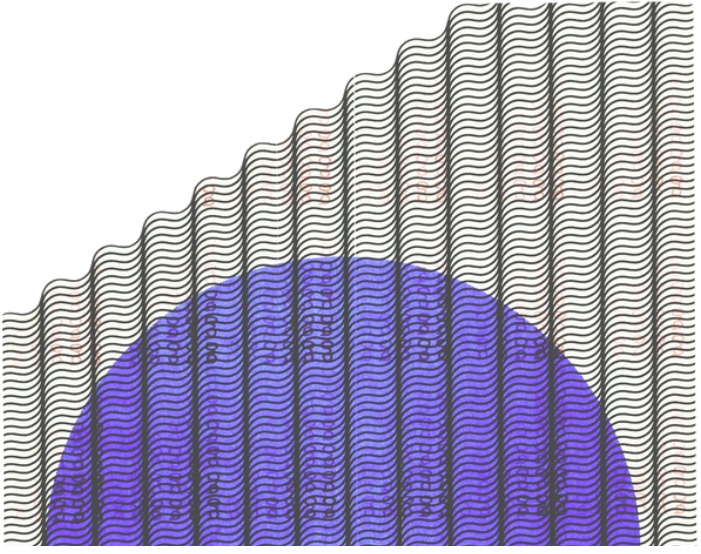
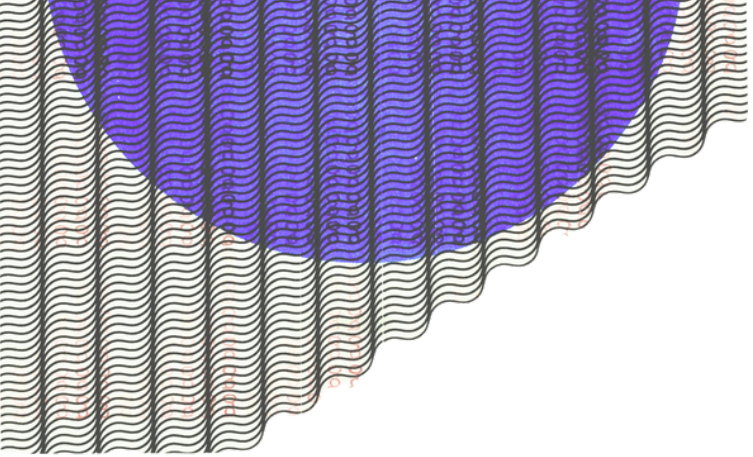
Almost the entire team is here answering questions, so whether you have questions for anyone in particular, the engineering department or the entire team, just drop them in the comments and we will answer them starting at 4 CEST.

Picture of @Stadicus and @douglas as proof:



psst... AMA means Ask Me Anything :)

reply \ 5 sats \ 1 reply \ @SimpleStacker 1 Jul
I don't feel very patriotic.
But I also get annoyed at people who seem to hate their own country, and who seem to hate capitalism and western civilization, which they've benefited so much from
reply \ 5 sats \ 0 replies \ @beeJay 1 Jul
I love my country. I don't love governments of any of them. I think it's completely fine to love one's country and not the tyranny of it.
reply \ 5 sats \ 0 replies \ @86b4dc92cd 1 Jul freebie
I love my country, but I wouldn't defend it no matter what. I believe no country is worth dying for.



Do you feel patriotic?

226 sats \ 8 comments \ @guerratotal 1 Jul AskSN #1019841

I've been reflecting a lot on the topic of patriotism lately. Perhaps because living outside my country makes one face that uncomfortable question more directly: do I really love my homeland? Do I feel patriotic?

I'm Cuban, and I'm proud of it. Proud of my people, of our history, of our music, of that unique blend of wit, resilience, and humor that we carry within us. But, honestly, I don't feel patriotic. I wouldn't fight for Cuba under the communist regime that governs it. I wouldn't lift a finger to defend that rotten structure that has only brought misery, control, and pain. I don't believe in that country as an institution, even though I love its essence and its people. Perhaps living and being born under a totalitarian regime kills the patriotism within people?

And now that I live in Brazil, I don't feel Brazilian either. I'm deeply grateful for the opportunity to be here, to work, and to provide a future for my family. But patriotism doesn't just appear when you cross a border. I'm not moved by the flag, nor do I feel proud when the national team plays. I feel like a respectful guest, but not part of something that deeply represents me.

I realize there's a difference between loving your culture and being a patriot. You can love your country and at the same time refuse to defend the system that corrupts it. You can value your roots without wanting to die for a flag.

That's why I'd like to open a survey, a conversation:

Do you feel patriotic? Do you love your country, its people, its culture? Are you proud of where you come from? Would you defend your nation no matter what, or does your love have limits when what it represents is corrupted?

I'm sure I'm not the only one experiencing this paradox.

102 sats \ 9 replies \ @aljaz 2 Jul

what do you think is the biggest issue with current state of self custody?

245 sats \ 7 replies \ @Stadicus 2 Jul

A big problem with self-custody is that there always remains one thing (like the backup) that gives full and immediate access to all your coins. This piece of information must be kept secure, but should also be easy to recover. It's hard to keep the backup secure, and as long as users at home have immediate access to all their funds, that can make them targets for the \$5-dollar-wrench-attack.

A few options that try to fix this:

Encrypting the backup --> not a good idea, as then you need a backup for your backup password. Makes inheritance hard, and basically creates a 2of2 scheme, where you lose either backup or password, your backup is useless. (The BitBox01 had an encrypted mSD).

Multisig --> still quite technical for normies and needs multiple signing devices and backup locations. Powerful, but UX should improve. Backup complexity (preserve xpubs etc) is quite high).

Bitcoin script solutions --> I have high hopes that we will see more "intelligent" bitcoin wallets soon, e.g. degrading multisig, timelocked backups, or other "not-instant" recovery paths that preserve full user sovereignty.

Not having instant access to your full stash should be normalized, so thieves can no longer assume that a "friendly visit" at home will pay off.

7 sats \ 2 replies \ @ek 2 Jul

What was the most surprisingly hard problem you encountered while building BitBox?
reply

0 sats \ 0 replies \ @Stadicus 2 Jul

From a product management perspective (not the actual chip-level programming), it's important to always get user feedback and build something that is really easy to use.

Making secure hardware simple might be the real challenge.

0 sats \ 0 replies \ @douglas 2 Jul

It is probably different for different people, but the hardest problems for me have been picking a name! There are no right answers :)

Technically for the BitBox02, it was actually figuring out the cardboard packaging - more than expected design considerations & iterations and production times.

Book Review: Nobody Wants Your Sh*t

1196 sats \ 27 comments \ @siggy47 30 Jun BooksAndArticles #1019138



This really isn't a book review, I'm not doing an in depth analysis, since the book doesn't warrant it. That's not meant to be a criticism, it's a light hearted, sometimes funny attempt to address an important topic. It was a timely discovery for me.

One of my lifelong best friends just died. I talked about him in various posts over the years. He was a hoarder, an indiscriminate book collector, and someone who took notes all day, on little scraps of paper for at least 50 years. Now his friends and family are tasked with disposing of all his crap, which is crammed into his one bedroom apartment and two storage units.

It got me thinking. I could have easily become a hoarder myself, had I not married a woman who would harass me about my clutter and secretly throw out my stuff without me realizing it.

The truth is we all have possessions that only we value. Not even your wife and kids will care about them once we're gone. Lately I have a desire to get rid of things. I don't think it's because I'm preparing to croak, but who knows. Regardless, I think this lighthearted book addresses a pretty serious subject. It is worth your time.

reply \ 191 sats \ 1 reply \ @carlosfandango 30 Jun
Asking the former Mrs Fandango during her Marie Kondo phase..

'But does this item bring joy darling'
'No... it strains the pasta. Idiot'

Eventually she got rid of another thing that didn't bring her joy either....
and it brought him a lot of peace!

